CLIENT PROJECT | RECRUITING FIRM · CANDIDATE OUTREACH

Replace the template with a real question.

A four-email cold sequence for TalentBridge, a recruiting firm, built around one question about candidate replies.

PROJECT 2 | APRIL 2025 | COPYWRITER: ABDUL TAHIR

Observational opening | Conversational tone | Soft CTA

AUDIENCE	Recruiting and hiring leads who send candidate outreach.
THE BRIEF	Recruiting emails tend to sound alike, and candidates notice. Generic outreach signals low effort, so it blends into the rest of the inbox and goes unanswered.
GOAL	Improve candidate reply rates by replacing templated recruiting outreach with copy that feels personal and human.
MY APPROACH	I opened with a plain question about reply rates instead of an introduction. The follow-ups explain what makes a message feel written for one person, show an example opening, and close with an easy way out.
DELIVERABLES	A four-email sequence with a subject line and a soft, reply-based call to action.

What shapes the copy

01 Observational opening
Email 1 starts from something the reader can check for themselves: whether their candidates are replying right now.

02 Conversational tone
A lowercase subject line, a first-name greeting and short lines. It reads like a note from a person, not a campaign.

03 Soft CTA
Every email ends by offering something small, a short note or an example. None of them asks for a call.

The sequence

Four emails over 13 days. Emails 2 to 4 continue in the same thread.

01 / EMAIL 1 • DAY 1
Start with the question

Subject: quick question about candidate replies

Hi [First Name],

Quick question: are your candidates actually replying to outreach right now?

I ask because [specific observation about their open roles or hiring activity]. I'm with TalentBridge, where we recruit for [roles or sector].

If replies have been slow, I can send a short note on how we write the first message to a candidate. No call needed.

Would that be useful?

[Sender Name]
TalentBridge

02 / EMAIL 2 • DAY 4
Explain what makes a message specific | Same email thread

Hi [First Name],

Candidates can usually tell within a line or two whether a message was written for them or for a list.

What helps is a specific reason for the contact: a project they've worked on, a skill the role needs, or a detail about the team.

That's the part I'd focus on for [role]. Is that how your outreach opens today?

[Sender Name]
TalentBridge

03 / EMAIL 3 • DAY 8
Show an example opening | Same email thread

Hi [First Name],

Here's the kind of opening I mean:

“[One line about a verified detail in the candidate's work, followed by why the role fits.]”

It's short, plain and easy to answer. I can draft one for [role] so you can compare it with your current message.

Want me to send it over?

[Sender Name]
TalentBridge

04 / EMAIL 4 • DAY 13
Close politely | Same email thread

Hi [First Name],

I'll leave this with you.

If candidate replies are on your list, reply and I'll send the example for [role]. If your outreach is already working well, there's nothing to change.

All the best,

[Sender Name]
TalentBridge

Copy decisions

WHY A QUESTION	A question the reader can answer in one line is easier to reply to than a pitch.
NO PITCH UP FRONT	The first email asks before it tells, which earns the right to say more in the follow-ups.
AN EXAMPLE, NOT A PROMISE	Email 3 shows the kind of opening line it means, so the reader can judge the approach for themselves.
A RESPECTFUL CLOSE	The final email accepts that the reader's outreach may already be working, which keeps the tone courteous.

Sequence at a glance

DAY	EMAIL	WHAT IT DOES
Day 1	Start with the question	Asks whether candidates are replying and offers a short note.
Day 4	Explain what makes a message specific	Describes the specific reason for contact that candidates respond to.
Day 8	Show an example opening	Offers to draft an opening line for a named role.
Day 13	Close politely	Leaves the offer open and accepts that nothing may need to change.

Need a sequence for your business?

Share your offer, target reader and the next step you want them to take.

abdultahir.co.uk | tahir@abdultahir.co.uk